machines by default. For example, many NoSQL database systems use a cluster of machines to replicate data. The benefit of doing so is low latency and high throughput. But be warned, this is for experts in the field of distributed systems and storage only. If in doubt, use EBS instead.

WARNING If you stop or terminate your EC2 instance, the instance store is lost. *Lost* means all data is destroyed and can't be restored!

Note that most EC2 instance types do not come with instance storage. Only some instance families come with instance storage included. AWS offers SSD and HDD instance stores from 4 GB up to 335,520 GB. Table 8.3 shows a few EC2 instance families providing instance stores.

Table 8.3 Instance families with instance stores

Use case	Instance type	Instance store type	Instance store size in GB
General purpose	m6id.large m6id.32xlarge	SSD	118 7600
Compute optimized	c6id.large c6id.32xlarge	SSD	118 7600
Memory optimized	r6id.large r6id.32xlarge	SSD	118 7600
Storage optimized	i4i.large i4i.32xlarge	SSD	468 30000
Storage optimized	d3.xlarge d3.8xlarge	HDD	5940 47520
Storage optimized	d3en.xlarge d3en.12xlarge	HDD	27960 335520